

Sehat Sathi

AI-Powered Health Support Multi-Agent System

Verified Health Knowledge Base (RAG Source Document)

This document contains curated, source-attributed medical guidance covering 19 common and emergency health conditions relevant to rural and semi-urban Pakistan. Content is paraphrased from established public health sources including the World Health Organization (WHO), MedlinePlus (U.S. National Library of Medicine), and the CDC, and is used as the grounding knowledge base for the Health Info Agent's retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) pipeline.

Disclaimer: This document provides general health guidance for informational purposes as part of an AI triage/guidance system. It is not a substitute for professional medical diagnosis or treatment. Emergency conditions are clearly marked and should always be escalated to in-person medical care.

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Fever (Bukhar)

Overview

Fever is a temporary rise in body temperature, usually above 100.4°F (38°C), and is most often a sign that the body's immune system is fighting an infection (viral or bacterial).

Common Symptoms

- Body temperature above 100.4°F (38°C)
- Sweating or chills
- Headache
- Muscle aches
- Weakness and fatigue
- Loss of appetite
- Dehydration

Causes

Most fevers are caused by common viral infections (flu, cold), bacterial infections, or in Pakistan specifically can be linked to malaria, typhoid, or dengue if it persists.

General Guidance / Home Care

- Drink plenty of fluids (water, ORS, clear soups) to prevent dehydration
- Rest as much as possible
- Wear light clothing and keep the room comfortably cool
- Paracetamol (acetaminophen) can be used at standard adult doses to reduce fever and discomfort; avoid aspirin in children
- Use a lukewarm sponge/cloth on the forehead if temperature is very high
- Monitor temperature every few hours

When to See a Doctor (Warning Signs)

- Fever above 103°F (39.4°C) that does not respond to medication
- Fever lasting more than 3 days
- Difficulty breathing, chest pain, or severe headache
- Confusion, stiff neck, or persistent vomiting
- Rash appearing alongside fever
- Signs of dehydration (very dark urine, dizziness, dry mouth)
- Fever in infants under 3 months (seek care immediately)

Source: World Health Organization (WHO), MedlinePlus

Cough and Common Cold (Khansi aur Zukam)

Overview

The common cold is a mild viral infection of the nose and throat, usually harmless and resolving on its own within 7-10 days. Cough can accompany a cold or occur on its own due to throat irritation or chest congestion.

Common Symptoms

- Runny or blocked nose
- Sore throat
- Sneezing
- Dry or productive (phlegm) cough
- Mild body ache
- Mild fever (sometimes)
- Watery eyes

Causes

Caused by viruses spread through droplets in the air or contact with contaminated surfaces. Cold weather, dust, and pollution can worsen symptoms.

General Guidance / Home Care

- Drink warm fluids such as tea with honey and ginger, or warm water
- Gargle with warm salt water for sore throat
- Steam inhalation can help relieve nasal congestion
- Get adequate rest and sleep
- Use honey for cough relief (not for children under 1 year)
- Keep hydrated throughout the day
- Avoid smoking or exposure to smoke/dust

When to See a Doctor (Warning Signs)

- Cough lasting more than 2-3 weeks
- High fever above 101°F alongside cough
- Difficulty breathing or wheezing
- Chest pain when coughing or breathing
- Coughing up blood or thick discolored mucus
- Symptoms worsening after initially improving

Source: World Health Organization (WHO), MedlinePlus

Diarrhea (Ishaal)

Overview

Diarrhea is the passing of loose or watery stools more than 3 times a day. It is usually caused by an infection in the intestinal tract from contaminated food or water and is a major health concern in areas with limited access to clean water.

Common Symptoms

- Frequent loose/watery stools
- Abdominal cramps
- Nausea or vomiting
- Mild fever
- Dehydration (in moderate to severe cases)

Causes

Contaminated food or water, viral or bacterial infections, parasites, or food intolerance.

General Guidance / Home Care

- Drink Oral Rehydration Solution (ORS) or a mix of clean water, salt, and sugar to replace lost fluids
- Continue eating small, frequent, bland meals (rice, bananas, toast) as tolerated
- Avoid dairy, oily, and spicy foods until recovered
- Wash hands frequently with soap
- Avoid untreated or unclean drinking water
- Zinc supplementation is recommended for children with diarrhea (as per WHO guidance)

When to See a Doctor (Warning Signs)

- Diarrhea lasting more than 2 days in adults, or more than 24 hours in children
- Signs of severe dehydration: sunken eyes, extreme thirst, little to no urination, dizziness
- Blood or mucus in stool
- High fever (above 102°F)
- Severe abdominal pain
- Diarrhea in infants or elderly (seek care sooner)

Source: World Health Organization (WHO), MedlinePlus

Headache (Sar Dard)

Overview

Headaches are one of the most common health complaints and are usually not serious. They can range from mild tension headaches to more intense migraines.

Common Symptoms

- Dull, aching pain, or throbbing sensation in the head
- Pain on one or both sides of the head
- Sensitivity to light or sound (in migraines)
- Neck stiffness (in tension headaches)
- Nausea (sometimes, with migraines)

Causes

Stress, dehydration, lack of sleep, eye strain, skipping meals, caffeine withdrawal, sinus congestion, or high blood pressure.

General Guidance / Home Care

- Rest in a quiet, dark room
- Drink water — dehydration is a common headache trigger
- Apply a cold or warm compress to the forehead or neck
- Paracetamol can be used at standard adult doses for pain relief
- Maintain regular sleep and meal schedules
- Reduce screen time and eye strain
- Practice relaxation or light stretching for stress-related headaches

When to See a Doctor (Warning Signs)

- Sudden, severe headache unlike any before ("worst headache of your life")
- Headache with fever, stiff neck, confusion, or rash
- Headache after a head injury
- Headache with vision changes, weakness, or difficulty speaking
- Headaches that are worsening or increasing in frequency
- Headache waking you from sleep repeatedly

Source: World Health Organization (WHO), MedlinePlus

Stomach Pain / Indigestion (Pait Dard)

Overview

Stomach pain and indigestion are common and usually caused by minor digestive issues, but can occasionally signal a more serious underlying condition.

Common Symptoms

- Cramping or aching pain in the abdomen
- Bloating or gas
- Nausea
- Burning sensation (heartburn/acidity)
- Discomfort after eating

Causes

Overeating, spicy or oily food, gas, mild food intolerance, acidity/gastritis, stress, or minor infections.

General Guidance / Home Care

- Eat smaller, more frequent meals instead of large ones
- Avoid spicy, oily, and heavy foods temporarily
- Drink warm water or herbal teas (e.g. ginger, mint) to ease digestion
- Avoid lying down immediately after eating
- Over-the-counter antacids can help with mild acidity
- Rest and avoid stressful situations if possible

When to See a Doctor (Warning Signs)

- Severe or persistent abdominal pain
- Pain localized to the lower right abdomen (possible appendicitis)
- Blood in vomit or stool
- Pain with high fever
- Yellowing of skin or eyes (jaundice)
- Inability to keep food or water down for over 24 hours
- Pain that worsens progressively rather than improving

Source: World Health Organization (WHO), MedlinePlus

Minor Cuts and Wounds (Mamuli Zakham)

Overview

Minor cuts, scrapes, and wounds are common injuries that can usually be treated safely at home with proper first aid.

Common Symptoms

- Break in the skin with mild bleeding
- Pain or tenderness around the area
- Mild swelling or redness

Causes

Accidental cuts from sharp objects, falls, scrapes, or minor household injuries.

General Guidance / Home Care

- Wash your hands before treating the wound
- Rinse the wound gently with clean water to remove dirt
- Apply gentle pressure with a clean cloth to stop any bleeding
- Apply an antiseptic (like povidone-iodine) to the area
- Cover with a clean bandage or dressing
- Change the dressing daily and keep the wound dry
- Watch for signs of infection over the following days

When to See a Doctor (Warning Signs)

- Bleeding that does not stop after 10-15 minutes of firm pressure
- Wound is deep, gaping, or has jagged edges
- Signs of infection: increasing redness, warmth, swelling, pus, or foul smell
- Wound caused by a rusty or dirty object (tetanus risk — may need a booster)
- Animal or human bite
- Numbness or inability to move the area near the wound
- Fever developing after the injury

Source: World Health Organization (WHO), MedlinePlus

Body Ache / Flu (Jism Dard aur Flu)

Overview

Influenza (flu) is a viral respiratory infection that causes widespread body aches along with fever, fatigue, and respiratory symptoms. It is more intense than a common cold.

Common Symptoms

- Sudden onset of fever and chills
- Muscle and body aches
- Fatigue and weakness
- Headache
- Dry cough
- Sore throat
- Runny or stuffy nose

Causes

Influenza viruses, spread through respiratory droplets, especially during seasonal outbreaks.

General Guidance / Home Care

- Get plenty of rest to allow the body to recover
- Drink fluids frequently to stay hydrated
- Take paracetamol for fever and body aches at standard doses
- Eat light, nutritious meals even if appetite is reduced
- Isolate from others where possible to prevent spreading the virus
- Use a humidifier or steam inhalation for congestion

When to See a Doctor (Warning Signs)

- Difficulty breathing or shortness of breath
- Chest pain or pressure
- Persistent high fever not responding to medication
- Symptoms that improve then suddenly worsen
- Severe weakness or dizziness
- Symptoms in someone elderly, pregnant, or with a chronic illness (seek care earlier)

Source: World Health Organization (WHO), MedlinePlus, CDC

Allergy and Skin Rash (Alergy aur Jild ki Kharish)

Overview

Allergic reactions occur when the body's immune system overreacts to a normally harmless substance (allergen), often causing skin, respiratory, or digestive symptoms.

Common Symptoms

- Itchy skin or rash
- Red, raised bumps (hives)
- Sneezing, runny nose, itchy eyes
- Mild swelling
- Dry, flaky, or irritated skin

Causes

Dust, pollen, certain foods, insect bites, new soaps/detergents, medications, or heat.

General Guidance / Home Care

- Identify and avoid the triggering allergen where possible
- Apply a cool, damp cloth to itchy or irritated skin
- Use over-the-counter antihistamine tablets or calamine lotion for mild itching
- Wear loose, breathable cotton clothing
- Keep the affected area clean and dry
- Avoid scratching to prevent skin infection

When to See a Doctor (Warning Signs)

- Difficulty breathing, throat tightness, or swelling of the face/lips/tongue (seek emergency care immediately — possible severe allergic reaction/anaphylaxis)
- Rash spreading rapidly or covering a large part of the body
- Rash accompanied by high fever
- Signs of skin infection (pus, increasing pain, warmth)
- Symptoms not improving after a few days of home care

Source: World Health Organization (WHO), MedlinePlus

Malaria

Overview

Malaria is a serious, life-threatening disease caused by parasites transmitted through the bite of infected female *Anopheles* mosquitoes. It remains a significant health concern in parts of Pakistan, especially rural and semi-urban areas.

Common Symptoms

- High fever with chills and sweating (often cyclical)
- Headache
- Muscle and joint pain
- Fatigue and weakness
- Nausea and vomiting
- Sometimes diarrhea

Causes

Plasmodium parasites transmitted by infected mosquito bites, typically more common during and after monsoon season when stagnant water increases mosquito breeding.

General Guidance / Home Care

- Malaria requires a blood test for diagnosis and specific antimalarial medication for treatment — it cannot be safely treated with home remedies alone
- Rest and drink plenty of fluids while awaiting or during treatment
- Take paracetamol for fever if advised by a health worker (avoid aspirin/ibuprofen)
- Use mosquito nets and repellents to prevent further bites during illness and recovery

When to See a Doctor (Warning Signs)

- Any fever with chills in a malaria-endemic area should be tested promptly
- Confusion, drowsiness, or difficulty waking
- Repeated vomiting preventing fluid intake
- Difficulty breathing
- Dark or reduced urine output
- Seizures
- Symptoms not improving within 48 hours of starting treatment

Note: Malaria can become severe quickly, especially in children and pregnant women. Prompt testing and treatment at a health facility is essential — this is not a condition to manage purely at home.

Source: World Health Organization (WHO), CDC

Typhoid Fever (Motijhara / Mian Mithi Bukhar)

Overview

Typhoid fever is a serious bacterial infection caused by *Salmonella Typhi*, spread through food or water contaminated with the bacteria. It remains common in parts of Pakistan and other developing regions with limited access to clean water and sanitation. Left untreated, it can be life-threatening.

Common Symptoms

- Fever that starts low and rises gradually over several days, sometimes reaching 103-104°F (39.5-40°C)
- General weakness and fatigue
- Headache
- Abdominal pain
- Loss of appetite
- Constipation or diarrhea
- "Rose spots" — small flat pink/red spots, mainly on the chest and abdomen (in some patients)
- Chills and sweating
- Dry cough
- In severe/late stages: confusion, delirium, severe fatigue

Causes

Ingestion of food or water contaminated with *Salmonella Typhi* bacteria, usually due to poor sanitation or contact with an infected carrier who has not washed their hands properly.

General Guidance / Solution

- Typhoid requires medical diagnosis (blood test/culture) and treatment with prescribed antibiotics — it cannot be safely treated at home with rest alone
- Complete the full course of antibiotics exactly as prescribed by a doctor, even if you start feeling better early
- Drink plenty of fluids and oral rehydration solution (ORS) to prevent dehydration
- Eat soft, easily digestible, nutritious food
- Rest as much as possible during recovery
- Wash hands thoroughly with soap after using the bathroom, and avoid preparing food for others while contagious, to prevent spreading the infection
- Typhoid vaccination is available and recommended in endemic areas, especially for children

When to See a Doctor (Warning Signs — see a doctor promptly for ANY suspected typhoid):

- Fever lasting more than 3 days, especially if gradually increasing
- High fever with abdominal pain and either constipation or diarrhea
- Rose-colored rash on chest/abdomen
- Confusion, extreme drowsiness, or disorientation
- Blood in stool
- Symptoms not improving within 48-72 hours of starting antibiotics
- Severe abdominal pain or swelling (possible complication — seek emergency care)

Note: Typhoid can become severe and life-threatening if untreated. Any suspected case should be evaluated by a healthcare provider promptly rather than managed with home remedies alone.

Source: World Health Organization (WHO), MedlinePlus, Mayo Clinic

Dengue Fever

Overview

Dengue is a viral illness spread by the bite of infected *Aedes* mosquitoes, common in Pakistan especially during and after monsoon season. Most cases are mild, but a small percentage can progress to severe dengue, which is a medical emergency.

Common Symptoms (Mild Dengue)

- Sudden high fever, often up to 104-105°F (40°C)
- Severe headache, especially pain behind the eyes
- Joint and muscle pain ("breakbone fever")
- Nausea and vomiting
- Skin rash (flat, red rash appearing a few days after fever starts)
- Fatigue

Causes

Bite from an *Aedes aegypti* mosquito infected with the dengue virus. Cannot spread directly from person to person.

General Guidance / Solution

- There is no specific antiviral medicine for dengue; treatment focuses on rest, fluids, and fever control
- Drink plenty of fluids (water, ORS, coconut water) to prevent dehydration
- Use paracetamol (acetaminophen) only for fever and pain
- Strictly avoid aspirin, ibuprofen, and other NSAIDs, as these can increase bleeding risk
- Rest in bed and monitor temperature regularly
- Sleep under a mosquito net and use mosquito repellent to prevent further bites and spread to others in the household
- Monitor closely for warning signs, especially as the fever starts to come down (24-48 hours after fever drops is the highest-risk window for severe dengue)

When to Seek Emergency Care Immediately (Warning Signs of Severe Dengue)

- Severe abdominal pain or tenderness
- Persistent vomiting (3 or more times in 24 hours)
- Bleeding from nose or gums, vomiting blood, or black/bloody stools
- Bleeding under the skin (looks like bruising) or small red spots
- Difficulty breathing or rapid breathing
- Extreme fatigue, restlessness, irritability, or drowsiness
- Cold, clammy, pale skin

Note: Severe dengue can become life-threatening within hours. Anyone showing warning signs — even if their fever has already improved — should go to the nearest hospital/emergency room immediately, not wait it out at home.

Source: World Health Organization (WHO), CDC, MedlinePlus

High Blood Pressure / Hypertension (Bulund Fishar-e-Khoon)

Overview

Hypertension is a chronic condition in which the force of blood against artery walls is consistently too high. It is often called a "silent" condition because it usually has no obvious symptoms but significantly raises the risk of heart disease, stroke, and kidney problems if left untreated.

Common Symptoms

- Often no symptoms at all (this is why regular blood pressure checks matter)
- In some cases: headaches, dizziness, blurred vision
- Shortness of breath (in more advanced or very high readings)
- Nosebleeds (uncommon, usually only with very high blood pressure)

Causes

Family history, high salt intake, obesity, lack of physical activity, smoking, excessive alcohol use, chronic stress, and age. Often it is a combination of lifestyle and genetic factors.

General Guidance / Solution

- Blood pressure should be checked regularly, since symptoms are often absent
- Reduce salt intake in daily meals
- Maintain a healthy body weight through balanced diet and regular exercise
- Limit fried, processed, and high-fat foods
- Avoid smoking and limit alcohol intake
- Manage stress through relaxation, adequate sleep, and physical activity
- If prescribed medication by a doctor, take it consistently and do not stop without medical advice, even if you feel fine
- Home monitoring with a blood pressure device can help track control over time

When to See a Doctor (Warning Signs)

- Blood pressure reading consistently above 140/90 mmHg
- Severe headache with blurred vision or confusion
- Chest pain or difficulty breathing
- Blood pressure reading above 180/120 mmHg (seek emergency care immediately — this is a hypertensive crisis)
- Sudden weakness, numbness, or difficulty speaking (possible stroke — emergency)
- Anyone newly diagnosed should have a follow-up plan with a doctor for ongoing management

Note: Hypertension is a long-term condition requiring regular monitoring and, often, ongoing medication — it is not something to self-manage without medical guidance once diagnosed.

Source: World Health Organization (WHO), MedlinePlus

Diabetes (Zeabetes / Sugar ki Bimari)

Overview

Diabetes is a chronic condition in which the body cannot properly regulate blood sugar (glucose) levels, either because it doesn't produce enough insulin (Type 1) or doesn't use insulin effectively (Type 2, the most common form). Pakistan has one of the highest diabetes prevalence rates in the world.

Common Symptoms

- Excessive thirst
- Frequent urination
- Unexplained weight loss
- Increased hunger
- Fatigue and weakness
- Blurred vision
- Slow-healing wounds or cuts
- Frequent infections
- Tingling or numbness in hands/feet (in longer-standing cases)

Causes

Type 2 diabetes (most common) is linked to obesity, poor diet, sedentary lifestyle, and family history. Type 1 diabetes is an autoimmune condition, often diagnosed in childhood or young adulthood.

General Guidance / Solution

- Diabetes requires diagnosis through a blood sugar test and ongoing management with a healthcare provider
- Follow a balanced diet: reduce sugar, refined carbohydrates, and processed foods; increase vegetables, whole grains, and fiber
- Engage in regular physical activity (e.g. brisk walking 30 minutes most days)
- Monitor blood sugar levels regularly as advised by a doctor
- Take prescribed medication or insulin exactly as directed — do not skip or adjust doses without medical guidance
- Maintain a healthy body weight
- Check feet regularly for cuts, sores, or numbness, and seek prompt care for any wounds
- Attend regular checkups to monitor for complications (eyes, kidneys, nerves)

When to See a Doctor (Warning Signs)

- Symptoms of high or low blood sugar that are unclear how to manage
- Blood sugar reading very high (above 300 mg/dL) or very low (below 70 mg/dL) with symptoms
- Confusion, difficulty speaking, or fainting (possible severe low blood sugar — emergency)
- Rapid breathing, fruity-smelling breath, nausea/vomiting, and confusion (possible diabetic ketoacidosis — emergency, especially in Type 1 diabetes)
- A wound or sore, especially on the feet, that is not healing or shows signs of infection
- Newly noticed symptoms such as excessive thirst, frequent urination, and unexplained weight loss (get tested)

Note: Diabetes is a lifelong condition that requires ongoing medical supervision — it cannot be managed through home remedies alone once diagnosed.

Source: World Health Organization (WHO), MedlinePlus

Asthma (Damma)

Overview

Asthma is a chronic condition in which the airways become inflamed, narrowed, and produce extra mucus, making breathing difficult. It can range from mild to severe and is often triggered by specific factors.

Common Symptoms

- Shortness of breath
- Wheezing (a whistling sound when breathing, especially breathing out)
- Chest tightness
- Coughing, especially at night or early morning
- Symptoms that worsen with exercise, cold air, or exposure to triggers

Causes / Common Triggers

Dust, smoke, pollen, cold air, strong odors, respiratory infections, exercise, and stress. Often runs in families and is linked with allergies.

General Guidance / Solution

- If diagnosed with asthma, always carry a rescue inhaler (bronchodilator) as prescribed and use it at the first sign of symptoms
- Identify and avoid personal triggers (dust, smoke, certain animals, strong perfumes)
- Take controller/preventive medication daily and consistently if prescribed, even when feeling well
- Keep the home environment clean and dust-free; use a mask if cleaning or exposed to dust/pollution
- Practice breathing exercises and maintain overall fitness as advised by a doctor
- Get an annual flu vaccine, as respiratory infections can trigger attacks
- Have a written asthma action plan from your doctor for managing flare-ups

When to Seek Emergency Care Immediately (Warning Signs of a Severe Attack)

- Severe difficulty breathing or gasping for air
- Unable to speak in full sentences due to breathlessness
- Lips or fingertips turning bluish/gray
- No improvement after using a rescue inhaler
- Rapid worsening of symptoms
- Chest retractions (skin pulling in around ribs with each breath)
- Confusion or extreme drowsiness during an attack

Note: A severe asthma attack is a medical emergency. If a rescue inhaler does not relieve symptoms quickly, seek emergency medical care immediately rather than waiting.

Source: World Health Organization (WHO), MedlinePlus

Urinary Tract Infection (UTI) (Peshab ki Nali ka Infection)

Overview

A urinary tract infection occurs when bacteria enter the urinary system (bladder, urethra, or kidneys), causing infection. It is more common in women but can affect anyone.

Common Symptoms

- Burning sensation during urination
- Frequent urge to urinate, even when little urine is passed
- Cloudy, dark, or strong-smelling urine
- Lower abdominal or pelvic pain/pressure
- Mild fever (in some cases)
- Blood in urine (in some cases)

Causes

Bacteria (commonly *E. coli*) entering the urinary tract, often related to hygiene, holding urine for long periods, dehydration, or after sexual activity.

General Guidance / Solution

- Drink plenty of water to help flush bacteria from the urinary system
- Urinate frequently and avoid holding urine for long periods
- Maintain good personal hygiene
- Avoid irritants such as harsh soaps in the genital area
- Mild cases may improve with increased fluid intake, but bacterial UTIs generally require antibiotics prescribed by a doctor after a urine test
- Over-the-counter pain relief may help with discomfort, but does not treat the underlying infection
- Do not stop antibiotics early even if symptoms improve, unless advised by your doctor

When to See a Doctor (Warning Signs)

- Burning urination or urinary symptoms lasting more than a day or two
- Fever with chills alongside urinary symptoms (possible kidney involvement)
- Back or side pain along with urinary symptoms
- Blood in urine
- Nausea or vomiting with urinary symptoms
- Recurrent UTIs (more than 2-3 times a year)
- UTI symptoms during pregnancy (seek care promptly)

Source: World Health Organization (WHO), MedlinePlus

Migraine

Overview

Migraine is a neurological condition causing recurrent, often severe headaches, frequently accompanied by other symptoms. It is more intense and disabling than a typical tension headache.

Common Symptoms

- Throbbing or pulsing pain, usually on one side of the head
- Sensitivity to light, sound, or smells
- Nausea or vomiting
- Visual disturbances before the headache (aura) in some people — flashing lights, blind spots, zigzag lines
- Pain that worsens with physical activity
- Duration ranging from a few hours to several days

Causes / Common Triggers

Stress, lack of sleep, certain foods (chocolate, caffeine, processed foods), hormonal changes, bright lights, strong smells, skipping meals, and dehydration.

General Guidance / Solution

- Rest in a dark, quiet room during an attack
- Apply a cold compress to the forehead or back of the neck
- Stay hydrated
- Over-the-counter pain relievers (like paracetamol or ibuprofen) can help if taken early in the attack, at standard doses
- Identify and track personal triggers using a headache diary
- Maintain regular sleep, meal, and hydration schedules
- Manage stress through relaxation techniques
- For frequent migraines, a doctor may prescribe preventive medication

When to See a Doctor (Warning Signs)

- Sudden, severe headache unlike any experienced before
- Migraine with fever, stiff neck, confusion, or rash
- Headache following a head injury
- New neurological symptoms: weakness, numbness, difficulty speaking, vision loss
- Migraines becoming more frequent or severe over time
- Migraine not responding to usual home care and over-the-counter medication

Source: World Health Organization (WHO), MedlinePlus

Food Poisoning (Khany ki Zeher Khurani)

Overview

Food poisoning results from eating food contaminated with bacteria, viruses, parasites, or toxins. Symptoms usually appear within hours of eating contaminated food and most cases resolve within a few days.

Common Symptoms

- Nausea and vomiting
- Watery diarrhea (sometimes with blood in severe cases)
- Abdominal cramps and pain
- Mild fever
- Weakness and fatigue
- Loss of appetite

Causes

Consuming food or water contaminated with bacteria (such as Salmonella, E. coli), viruses, or toxins — often from improperly stored, undercooked, or unhygienically prepared food.

General Guidance / Solution

- Rest and allow the stomach to settle
- Drink small, frequent sips of clear fluids or ORS to prevent dehydration
- Gradually reintroduce bland foods (rice, toast, bananas) once vomiting stops
- Avoid dairy, caffeine, alcohol, and fatty or spicy foods until fully recovered
- Wash hands frequently, especially before eating and after using the bathroom
- Avoid preparing food for others while symptomatic

When to See a Doctor (Warning Signs)

- Signs of dehydration: dizziness, dry mouth, little or no urination, extreme thirst
- Blood in vomit or stool
- High fever (above 102°F)
- Diarrhea lasting more than 2-3 days
- Severe abdominal pain
- Symptoms in infants, elderly, pregnant women, or those with chronic illness (seek care sooner)
- Signs of confusion or severe weakness

Source: World Health Organization (WHO), MedlinePlus, CDC

Chest Pain (Seene mein Dard) — EMERGENCY RED-FLAG SYMPTOM

Overview

Chest pain can have many causes ranging from minor (muscle strain, acidity) to life-threatening (heart attack). Because it is impossible to safely distinguish the cause without medical evaluation, ANY new, severe, or unexplained chest pain — especially combined with other warning signs — should be treated as a medical emergency until proven otherwise.

High-Risk Warning Signs (Seek Emergency Care IMMEDIATELY — do not wait or try home remedies):

- Chest pain described as pressure, tightness, squeezing, or crushing
- Pain spreading to the arm (especially left arm), jaw, neck, or back
- Chest pain with shortness of breath
- Chest pain with sweating, nausea, or vomiting
- Chest pain with dizziness, lightheadedness, or fainting
- Chest pain with an irregular or rapid heartbeat
- Chest pain lasting more than a few minutes or that comes and goes
- Chest pain in someone with a history of heart disease, high blood pressure, diabetes, or a smoker

What To Do

- Call emergency services or get to the nearest hospital/emergency room immediately
- Do not drive yourself if possible — have someone else take you or call an ambulance
- If available and not allergic, chewing an aspirin (325mg) while awaiting emergency care may be advised by emergency dispatchers, but this should not delay seeking care
- Stay calm, sit in a comfortable position, and avoid physical exertion while awaiting help

Lower-Risk Possibilities (still requires evaluation, but less immediately dangerous):

- Sharp pain that worsens with specific movement or breathing (may suggest muscle strain)
- Burning pain after eating that improves with antacids (may suggest acid reflux/heartburn)

Note: Even these should be evaluated by a doctor if new or persistent, as it is not safe to self-diagnose chest pain.

IMPORTANT: This information is not a substitute for emergency medical evaluation. Any significant or unexplained chest pain warrants immediate professional assessment. This is a case where the AI Triage Agent should always classify as EMERGENCY and direct the patient to the nearest hospital or emergency service without delay.

Source: World Health Organization (WHO), MedlinePlus, American Heart Association

Difficulty Breathing / Shortness of Breath (Saans Lenay mein Dushwari) — EMERGENCY RED-FLAG SYMPTOM

Overview

Difficulty breathing can range from mild (due to anxiety or mild asthma) to life-threatening (severe asthma attack, allergic reaction, pneumonia, heart failure, choking). Because breathing problems can worsen very quickly, sudden or severe breathing difficulty should always be treated as a medical emergency.

High-Risk Warning Signs (Seek Emergency Care IMMEDIATELY)

- Sudden onset of severe shortness of breath
- Gasping for air or struggling to breathe
- Unable to speak in full sentences due to breathlessness
- Lips, face, or fingertips turning blue or gray (cyanosis)
- Chest pain accompanying breathing difficulty
- Wheezing or a whistling sound that is worsening and not relieved by a rescue inhaler (if asthmatic)
- Swelling of the face, lips, tongue, or throat (possible severe allergic reaction/anaphylaxis)
- Rapid, shallow breathing with confusion or extreme drowsiness
- Breathing difficulty after a known allergen exposure (insect sting, food, medication)
- Choking on food or an object with inability to speak, cough, or breathe

What To Do

- Call emergency services or get to the nearest hospital/emergency room immediately
- If the person has a known allergy and an epinephrine auto-injector, use it immediately if signs of severe allergic reaction are present, then still proceed to emergency care
- If asthmatic and a rescue inhaler is available, use it while arranging emergency transport — but do not delay care if there is no improvement
- Keep the person calm and sitting upright if possible, as this can ease breathing
- If choking and the person cannot speak/cough/breathe, perform back blows/abdominal thrusts if trained, and call for emergency help immediately

Lower-Risk Possibilities (still requires prompt evaluation)

- Mild breathlessness with exertion in someone with known, well-controlled asthma (follow their action plan first)
- Breathlessness related to anxiety or panic, without other warning signs (should still be evaluated if new or recurrent)

IMPORTANT: This information is not a substitute for emergency medical care. Sudden, severe, or worsening breathing difficulty — especially combined with any other warning sign — should always be classified as EMERGENCY by the Triage Agent, directing the patient to seek immediate emergency care rather than home guidance.

Source: World Health Organization (WHO), MedlinePlus, CDC